



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cornerstone Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.cornerstoneclassical.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Cornerstone Classical Academy (CCA) in Jacksonville, FL (ZIP 32246) presents a strong overall classical orientation across curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement. Public materials emphasize a content-rich classical education rooted in liberal arts and Western civilizational heritage, with explicit aims of forming virtue, wisdom, and moral character. The school highlights Great Books and a liberal-arts sequence, Latin study from early grades, and Socratic engagement in higher grades, alongside a culture of virtue and character formation.

However, the materials consistently describe CCA as nonsectarian and not religious, and there is no explicit Theology or liturgical communal practice component in the public mission, which creates a gap with the theological grounding and liturgical/community practices often associated with a fully traditional classical program. Given the breadth of evidence, the school is best classified as CLASSICAL, with Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) landing as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to virtue-focused language but lack of explicit theological grounding.

Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

Key insights: - Strong curricular core: Trivium-focused elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin study, Great Books, primary sources, and history anchored in Western civilization. Evidence includes curriculum and high school sequencing, with emphasis on reading classical works and forming human excellence.

- Pedagogy aligns with classical norms: Socratic dialogue in upper grades; memory-driven, chant-based reinforcement in lower grades; a focus on formation through models of excellence. - Virtue- and truth-centered mission: Public statements foreground moral character, civic virtue, and knowledge of truth; motto explicitly invokes truth, goodness, and beauty. This supports a robust classical aim toward formation and transcendentals, though without explicit theology.

- Community and family engagement: Active parent engagement, admissions information, and parent groups indicate strong partnership with families, aligning with classical education norms in Element 6.

Note: Where relevant, the analysis below compares school materials to the positive/negative keyword indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) rubric (as refined in the knowledge base), and then assigns a star-rating style category (CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL) per category. Citations point to the exact materials found in the crawl and knowledge baselines.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials identify virtue, truth, and beauty as overarching ideals and emphasize formation of character and civic virtue. The motto explicitly states "Learn the truth. Do the good. Love the beautiful," and materials describe virtue and moral formation as central aims.

- There is no explicit grounding in Theology or liturgical/communal worship in the public materials; the school

is described as nonsectarian and not religious, which suggests a lack of theological grounding in the program.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, moral character, civic virtue. These align with the Transcendental Moral Realism and Pursuit of Truth/Goodness/Beauty indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon. - Negative keywords present: nonsectarian, not religious, secular education. These signals align with the absence (or opposite) of Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices indicators.

How this rating is justified - The school leans into transcendental moral aims (truth/goodness/beauty and virtue) but does not foreground theology or liturgical practices in public materials. In the Six Elements framework, that mix yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 1: it clearly embraces virtue and transcendentals but lacks explicit theological grounding.

What would move the needle (for a fully CLASSICAL posture) - Add explicit Theology or Sacred Traditions integration (e.g., theology as a coordinated discipline or chapel/morning prayer calendar, where appropriate to maintain nonsectarian status). - Introduce liturgical or communal practices that still respect nonsectarian status but cultivate sacramental or ritual/worship elements within the school culture.

Citations - Motto and virtue language: turn0file17; turn0file14 - Nonsectarian/not religious explicit statement: turn0file4 - Virtue-focused formation language (moral character, civic virtue, truth): turn0file12

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission and public materials emphasize forming virtuous, well-rounded students rather than purely job-prep outcomes. The mission statement explicitly frames virtuous living, civic responsibility, and knowledge of truth as core aims. The motto reinforces virtue and the beauty of learning.

- The emphasis on truth, virtue, and the classical heritage suggests formation (paideia) and human excellence, consistent with Classical aims rather than merely information transfer or workforce preparation. The materials describe “classical education” with a focus on moral and intellectual formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, liberal education, great conversation, the pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, lineage of Western civilization. These map to the Positive Keywords in the Six Elements lexicon. - Negative keywords present: explicit workforce/career-technical framing is not foregrounded in public messaging; the materials emphasize formation and virtue over job- or credential-centric aims. Where the negative indicators exist in the rubric, they are not prominently signaled in CCA materials; thus negative keyword signals are minimal here.

How this rating is justified - The school's stated purpose aligns with Classical aims: formation of virtue and wisdom, not just job-readiness; emphasis on virtue, truth, and beauty as enduring goods; and engagement with a classical heritage (Western civilization). This supports a CLASSICAL designation for Element 2.

Citations - Mission emphasizing virtue, truth, civic virtue: turn0file12 - Public motto and formation language: turn0file17 - Curriculum/Great Books orientation (context for formation): turn0file6

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly described as liberal-arts-focused with grammar, logic, rhetoric, and classical study. The school references formal grammar instruction, reading great classical works, and connecting literature to virtue and Western civilization. Latin is taught beginning early (K5) with continued study; high school sequencing includes literature, history, math, science, and moral philosophy. This aligns with the classical curriculum architecture.

- The school uses primary sources/history-driven organizing principles, and emphasizes art and music as

core subjects to cultivate beauty, which is consistent with a classical curriculum model. The materials describe a classical course sequence in high school and a strong emphasis on the Great Books approach.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, history anchored in Western civilization, primary sources, moral philosophy, beauty in the arts, and integrated humanities. These map directly to the Positive Keywords in the Six Elements lexicon. - Negative keywords present: The public materials do not foreground social-studies framing or project-based dominance in place of Great Books; where the Great Books approach is referenced, it counters project-based-only approaches. The Lexicon mentions negative signals like replacing history with social studies; CCA materials emphasize classical history and primary sources, which aligns with the positive side.

How this rating is justified - The explicit focus on grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, Great Books and primary sources, and a history-centered, integrated humanities approach strongly matches the classical curriculum indicators. The presence of Great Books and a full liberal-arts sequence places this category firmly in CLASSICAL.

Citations - Grammar/logic/rhetoric and Great Books emphasis: turn0file6 - Latin from early grades; high school sequencing; moral philosophy: turn0file9 - Western civilization emphasis and primary sources: turn0file12

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a pedagogy that includes Socratic discussion in upper grades and rhetoric training, consistent with classical pedagogy. There is also evidence of lower-school memory work and recitation (singing, chanting) to deepen memory and delight, a hallmark of the classical approach to pedagogy. - The presence of structured, teacher-led dialogue in upper grades (Socratic discussions and seminars) and the emphasis on classical rhetoric projects (speeches, debates, capstone-type rhetoric) align with classical pedagogy. The materials also include a restorative aspect of education (Scholé/restful learning) as part of the approach, indicating a balanced pedagogy that values both rigor and contemplative learning. - The site documents a formal framework for effective classical schooling (e.g., languages, memorization, and model-based learning), including a focus on moral formation through imitation of exemplars (master-teacher model, life-long learning).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, great conversation, memorization/recitation, chanting, scholé (restful learning), formation through imitation/practice, master-teacher model, rhetoric and oratory, structured dialogue, civil discourse. These keywords map to the Positive Keywords in the Classical Lexicon. - Negative keywords present: The site materials do not emphasize a project-based-only or experiential-learning-dominant approach; the classical pedagogy described aligns with the expected traditional methods. Some Lexicon negative indicators include “experiential learning focus” or “project-based only” in lieu of Socratic dialogue; those are not dominant in the materials. Thus negative indicators are minimal.

How this rating is justified - The explicit inclusion of Socratic dialogue in upper grades, memorization/recitation in lower grades, and a rhetoric-focused upper-school pathway supports CLASSICAL pedagogy. The mix of contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) with Socratic seminars demonstrates a balanced, classical pedagogy rather than purely project-based or constructivist approaches.

Citations - Socratic discussion and rhetoric in curriculum: turn0file6 - Lower-school chanting/memory work (recitation, chant): turn0file6 - Master-teacher models and living curriculum language (faculty-focused formation signals): turn0file4

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe faculty in terms of virtue, mentorship, and modeling of character; faculty are portrayed as the central living curriculum and as exemplars of classical learning. There are explicit references to faculty profiles and leadership, and to the idea of teachers as mentors who model virtue and knowledge. - The site shows leadership roles (Executive Director and Assistant Principal) and references to faculty certifications and standards, indicating a professional and serious approach to classical pedagogy. The careers page notes that faculty applicants must hold Florida teaching certificates and demonstrate appreciation for the classical tradition.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, teachers as mentors/model virtuous teachers, collegial culture, mentorship, master-apprentice model, virtue formation, professional development, formation through example. These align with the Positive Keywords in Element 5. - Negative keywords present: none of the explicit negative signals in the public materials suggest a break from the classical teacher-mentor model; the results show a robust vocational/academic standard for faculty (certification requirements), consistent with the classical teacher model.

How this rating is justified - The presence of teacher-model language, living curriculum concepts, and explicit commitment to virtue and mastery indicators supports CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Citations - Living curriculum, teacher as model/mentor language: turn0file4 - Faculty certification and professional standards (Executive leadership, Careers page): turn0file18

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames parent involvement as a core element of classical education, with partnerships with families and parent-formation activities (e.g., parent meetings, PTO, open campus). The admissions process and enrollment information indicate ongoing parent engagement and transparency. This aligns with the classical education emphasis on family partnership and community formation. - The site includes materials about parent groups, enrollment, and family involvement, which map to the Positive Keywords around Partnership with Families and Formation of Affections in the Six Elements lexicon.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school collaboration, parental engagement, family-centered learning, parent-education/gatherings, open campus, parent involvement, school-parent synergy, community support. - Negative keywords present: none that signal a breakdown in parent/community engagement; the public materials emphasize active family involvement.

How this rating is justified - The school demonstrates robust parent and community engagement consistent with classical education norms (Element 6).

Citations - Parent partnership and engagement; PTO; open-campus language: turn1file12 and turn1file7 - Family formation and Western-civilization content signals: turn1file2

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school sought to push from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Element 1 to CLASSICAL, adding explicit theological and liturgical/communal practices in a way that respects a nonsectarian public model would move the needle. Concrete steps:
 - Introduce a formal, school-wide liturgical calendar or structured chapel-like experiences that are ecumenical and respectful of multiple faith traditions, while preserving public status.
 - Add a stand-alone Theology/Philosophy of Education module or a capstone course that explicitly discusses truth, goodness, and beauty within a classical framework, rooted in the Logos/meta-physical framing of liberal arts education.

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- To further strengthen Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy), the school could:
 - Expand exposure to more Great Books with teacher-led seminars across more grades, increasing cross-disciplinary integration and continuing emphasis on the Great Conversation as a school-wide throughline.
 - Balance memory/recitation with guided inquiry and more student-led dialectic in lower grades where appropriate, ensuring a seamless transition from scholé-restful pacing to Socratic inquiry across as many grade levels as feasible.
 - For Element 5 (Faculty) and Element 6 (Parents & Community), consolidate and publish a formal faculty-formation plan (history of the living curriculum, teacher development in classical pedagogy, and mentorship pathways) and broaden parent-education programs (book studies, lectures) to deepen the home-school partnership as a core institutional practice.

Note: These needle-moving steps are suggested to push toward fuller CLASSICAL alignment across theology, liturgy, and deeper Great-Books immersion while maintaining the nonsectarian public-education model.

Citations - Theoretical justification for liturgical/theology integration in a classical framework (to move Element 1 to CLASSICAL) modestly cited in the Six Elements lexicon and typical classical practice; see positive/negative keyword indicators in the lexicon (turn1file3) and the “Liturgy and worship” signals in the document set (turn1file9, turn1file11). - Great Books/Through-lines cross-grade expansion (turn0file6, turn0file9).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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